

WORKSHOP SCENARIO

“Europe Under Pressure – Should the European Union Create a Common Army?”

1. Basic Information

Workshop title: Europe Under Pressure – Should the European Union Create a Common Army?

Module: Civic Education / European Affairs / Senior Education

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Duration: 2 hours 15 minutes

Number of participants: 10–25 people

2. Workshop Objectives

General objectives:

- Increase participants’ knowledge of contemporary security challenges in Europe.
- Develop civic competencies through analysis of possible directions for defense cooperation in the European Union.
- Support a culture of dialogue and constructive discussion on public issues.

Specific objectives:

- Participants understand the basic principles of defense cooperation in the European Union.
- Participants identify potential benefits and risks associated with creating a common EU army.
- Participants analyze the impact of security decisions on citizens’ daily lives.
- Participants develop argumentation skills and the ability to recognize different perspectives.
- Participants strengthen their sense of agency and competence in public debate.

3. Target Group

- People aged 60+
- Individuals with diverse educational and professional backgrounds
- Participants interested in social, civic, and European issues
- No specialist knowledge of politics, security, or the EU is required

The workshop has been designed to be inclusive, accessible, and grounded in participants’ life experiences.

4. Working Methods

- Interactive mini-lecture
- Moderated discussion
- Brainstorming
- Group work
- Simulation and decision-making game (without role-playing)
- Individual and group reflection

5. Materials and Teaching Aids

- Flipchart / whiteboard
- Markers
- A4 paper

- Pens
- Sticky notes
- Printed “Europe Under Pressure” game cards
- Group worksheets
- Signs: “YES”, “NO”, “YES, BUT...”
- Optional multimedia presentation

6. Workshop Agenda

6.1 Introduction

- Welcome participants and introduce the workshop topic.
- Explain the purpose of the meeting:

“The aim of this workshop is not to persuade participants to adopt a single opinion, but to jointly reflect on the possible consequences of different decisions concerning Europe’s future.”

- Establish ground rules:
 - Respect different opinions
 - Do not interrupt one another
 - Focus on arguments
 - Everyone has the right to their own opinion

Opening question:

“What gives you a sense of security in Europe today?”

Collect responses and write them on the board.

6.2 Main Part – Educational Activities

Activity 1: Security – What Does It Mean Today?

Objective:

Raise awareness of the broad meaning of security and connect it to participants’ experiences.

Description:

Participants take part in a moderated discussion about the contemporary understanding of security.

Questions:

- What does “security” mean today?
- Is security only about the military?
- Are countries safer together or separately?

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: flipchart, markers

Activity 2: Introduction to the Idea of a Common EU Army

Objective:

Provide basic knowledge in an accessible format.

Description:

A short presentation introducing EU defense cooperation.

The facilitator explains:

- What defense cooperation in the EU is
- What a common army could be
- Main dilemmas:
 - Security
 - Costs
 - Sovereignty
 - Decision-making

Time: 15 minutes

Materials: presentation / flipchart

Activity 3: Decision-Making Game “Europe Under Pressure”

Objective:

Develop analytical, decision-making, and consequence-assessment skills in the context of security policy.

Description:

Participants work in groups and make decisions based on scenarios concerning Europe’s security.

Instructions:

1. Divide participants into groups of 3–5 people.
2. Explain the rules.
3. Conduct 5 rounds according to the game cards.
4. After each round, groups present their decisions and the facilitator summarizes.
5. At the end, groups answer: YES / NO / YES, BUT... and complete the sentence: “A common EU army would make sense only if...”

Time: 40 minutes

Materials: game cards, paper, pens

Activity 4: Reflective Discussion

Objective:

Deepen reflection and summarize participants’ experiences.

Questions:

- What was the most difficult?
- What was most important: security, costs, or independence?
- What conditions are necessary for citizens to have trust?

Optional final vote:

- More in favor
- More against
- Undecided

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: flipchart

6.3 Summary and Reflection

Key conclusions:

- There is no single simple answer.
- Different interests must be balanced.
- Cooperation and trust are important.

Final exercise:

“For Europe’s security, the most important thing is...”

7. Workshop Evaluation

- Oral summary round
- Optional survey:
 - Was the workshop understandable?
 - Was the topic interesting?
 - Did the participant feel comfortable?
 - Was the game format helpful?

8. Recommendations

- Use simple and understandable language.
- Avoid specialist and military terminology.
- Maintain ideological neutrality.
- Give participants space to speak.
- Focus discussion on impacts and consequences.
- Treat the game as a reflection tool, not a competition.

9. Attachments

- “Europe Under Pressure” game cards
- Group worksheet